

August 12, 2026

Medicare (Palmetto GBA, JM MAC)
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Lacey Blick (MRN MUSC5011960), Claim MUSC-20260615-7F37-2

Patient	Lacey Blick (DOB 1989-07-13)
MRN	MUSC5011960
Member ID / Group	MED452021070 / GRP-92164
Claim number	MUSC-20260615-7F37-2
Date of service	2026-06-15
Procedure billed	CPT 59400 — Routine obstetric care including antepartum, vaginal delivery
Primary diagnosis	Z34.90 — Encounter for supervision of normal pregnancy, unspecified
Denied amount	\$16,913.91
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-11-25

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center submits this first-level redetermination request to Palmetto GBA (JM MAC) on behalf of patient Lacey Blick (MRN: MUSC5011960, Member ID: MED452021070) regarding Claim ID MUSC-20260615-7F37-2, with a date of service of June 15, 2026. The claim was denied in full on July 28, 2026, under CARC 16 / RARC N290, with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid," citing a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. The total billed amount of \$16,913.91 remains unpaid. This appeal is submitted prior to the redetermination deadline of November 25, 2026, and is accompanied by corrected claim documentation establishing the valid National Provider Identifier (NPI) for the rendering provider.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Blick, a 37-year-old female, presented to MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center on June 15, 2026, in an obstetric emergency hospital admission (place of service 23 — Emergency Room Hospital). Services were rendered by Robert K. Lindqvist, MD, under CPT code 59400, representing routine obstetric care including antepartum care and vaginal delivery. The primary diagnosis reported on the claim is Z34.90 (Encounter for supervision of normal pregnancy, unspecified), with a secondary diagnosis of R69. Ms. Blick carries an active diagnosis of hypertension managed with Hydrochlorothiazide, a relevant comorbidity in the context of obstetric care. The services billed reflect a complete episode of obstetric care as documented in the medical record.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is CARC 16 / RARC N290 — a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. This is a correctable billing error, not a clinical or medical necessity determination. The rendering provider, Robert K. Lindqvist, MD, holds NPI 1314059687, which is an active, valid Type 1 NPI enrolled with Medicare. Upon internal review of the original claim submission, MUSC Health identified that the rendering provider NPI was either absent or formatted incorrectly in the applicable claim loop, resulting in the system edit that triggered this denial. This does not reflect any deficiency in the care provided, the medical necessity of the services, or the accuracy of the diagnosis and procedure codes reported.

Medicare regulations and Palmetto GBA billing guidelines require that the rendering provider's NPI appear correctly in the designated field of the claim. MUSC Health acknowledges the submission error and has taken corrective action. A corrected claim with the rendering provider NPI 1314059687 properly populated is submitted concurrently with this redetermination request. The allowed amount previously calculated by the payer at \$9,090.20 confirms that the claim was otherwise adjudicable on its merits; the sole impediment to payment was the identifier error now corrected. Denial of the entire billed amount of \$16,913.91 on this administrative basis, when the underlying services are covered and the provider is enrolled, is not consistent with proper claim adjudication under Medicare fee-for-service rules.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Palmetto GBA reverse the denial of Claim ID MUSC-20260615-7F37-2 and reprocess the corrected claim to payment at the applicable Medicare allowable rate. The corrected claim, which includes the valid rendering provider NPI 1314059687 for Dr. Robert K. Lindqvist, is submitted with this redetermination request for immediate adjudication. Should additional documentation be required — including provider enrollment verification, the operative or delivery record, or facility attestation — MUSC Health will supply it promptly upon request.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record